ASRock at Computex 2012
ASRock introduced three boards for the enthusiasts at Computex this year namely: Z77 OC Formula, X79 Extreme 11 and Z77 Extreme 6/TB4

Thunderbolt explained
Tomshardware has this very interesting article telling you about Thunderbolt tech
http://dgit.in/Leohru

The Z77 Manifesto

Out in the market to build an Ivy Bridge rig? Read on which **Z77** board will give you the best bang for your buck

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Just prior to the launch of the Ivy Bridge processors, Intel had announced the Z77 chipset-based motherboards. The Z77 chipset replaces the Z68 chipset which was launched last year, but the socket remains the same ie. LGA 1155. This effectively means that all your Sandy Bridge processors will work on the Z77 boards. So the first question that we and most of our readers had was – what is the difference between Z77 and Z68 and does it make sense to upgrade to Z77 chipset if I have just purchased a Z68 board?

While the Z77 board does offer native USB 3.0 support and PCIe 3.0 support, on the whole it is not very different from a Z68 board. So if you have a Z68 board, no need to upgrade; but if you are in the market looking at building a new Ivy Bridge rig, this article is custom-made for you.

UNDER ₹13,000

This segment had around six boards: two from Gigabyte and one each from ASUS, MSI, ASRock and Foxconn. Yes, Foxconn the manufacturing hub, which is behind the peripherals on most motherboards, have started coming out with their own boards to sell in India. The one we got was the Z77A – S which is the only Z77 board in Foxconn's motherboard lineup. For a basic board, it has features such as a dedicated power/reset button and a POST error LED. But, it was the only board which sported the non-UEFI BIOS, which pales in comparison to the improved UEFI BIOSes seen on competing boards. It comes with a software utility Fox One to overclock from Windows. Overclocking via the BIOS was not as smooth as we would have liked. The VRM heatsink is absent thereby providing no cooling for the MOSFETS.

Gigabyte had the Z77 G1 Sniper M3 and the Z77X-UD3H boards here. For a gaming board, the Sniper M3 does not have dedicated power/reset buttons or a POST code readout. The main power connector is just a 4-pin one. It does support 2-way GPU setup and it is one of the only boards to sport a Creative CA0132 audio controller. We can overlook the limited number of SATA ports as you will most likely not be connecting more HDDs. The Gigabyte Z77X-UD3H on the other hand is proper mainstream board with interesting line up of features such as dedicated power/rest buttons, a POST error LED and even voltage check points and also an on-board mSATA connector to which you can attach a separate mSATA SSD for using Intel SSD caching feature. We felt that the VRM heatsink could have been much better. Both the boards sport a new digital PWM controller which provides auto-voltage compensation which delivers steady power flow to both memory